



Understanding salt

What does James Bond have to do with iodised salt? Find out in this column by Vir Sanghvi. <https://digit.in/apr20-55>



Salt in toothpaste

Toothpaste brands advertise the presence of salt in their tubes, but does this addition actually help? <https://digit.in/apr20-56>

SALTS

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EARTH

There is a staggering variety of salt consumed around the world, from white to pink to black.

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alt is an essential component of the diet for all humans. Almost all the salt that we eat comes

from the oceans. These salts are known as sea salts. Some salts are mined from the ground, but they are also ancient seas that have dried up, leaving behind the deposits in the rocks. However, these salts that are dug up are known as rock salt. Now all salts, whether rock salt or sea salt, can additionally be categorised based on

when they are added to the food. Cooking salt is rough, and is used during the process of preparing the food. Finishing salt is fine, and is served on the table. This can be added to the food as per the requirements of the eater.

Some of these salts are extremely local. A visit to the town of Lonar in Maharashtra will let you buy various salts from the Lonar crater, varieties with names such as Nimak Dalla, Khuppal, Papri and Bhuski. The origin of these salts are not yet ascertained, as feeder streams to the crater cannot possibly provide so much salt. These salts are often mixed together in different proportions to give even more variety. Here is a look at all the interesting salts around the world.

SALTS WITH MINERALS

One of the most well known local varieties of salt, is the Himalayan Pink salt. The salt is mined from the Punjab region in Pakistan. Most of the salt

comes from a single mine, the Khewra Salt Mine, which is the world's second largest salt mine. Legend has it that the salt was discovered in 320 BC, when Alexander's Army crossed the Jhelum. Apparently, the exhausted horses of the army were able to recover by licking the salty rocks, which allowed the accompanying soldiers to discover the mine. However, salt from the mine began to be traded only in the Moghul era. The distinct red colouration comes from trace quantities of iron. There is a belief that the Himalayan Pink salt is more healthy than the regular salt, however this has not been scientifically proven. In fact, Himalayan Salt is not iodised, which can actually cause deficiencies. There is also a Peruvian pink salt, which is extracted from the Qoripujio spring high up in the Andes mountain ranges. While the Andes may be a mountain now, it was once an ancient sea bed. The salt is extracted using about 5,000 small family owned salt